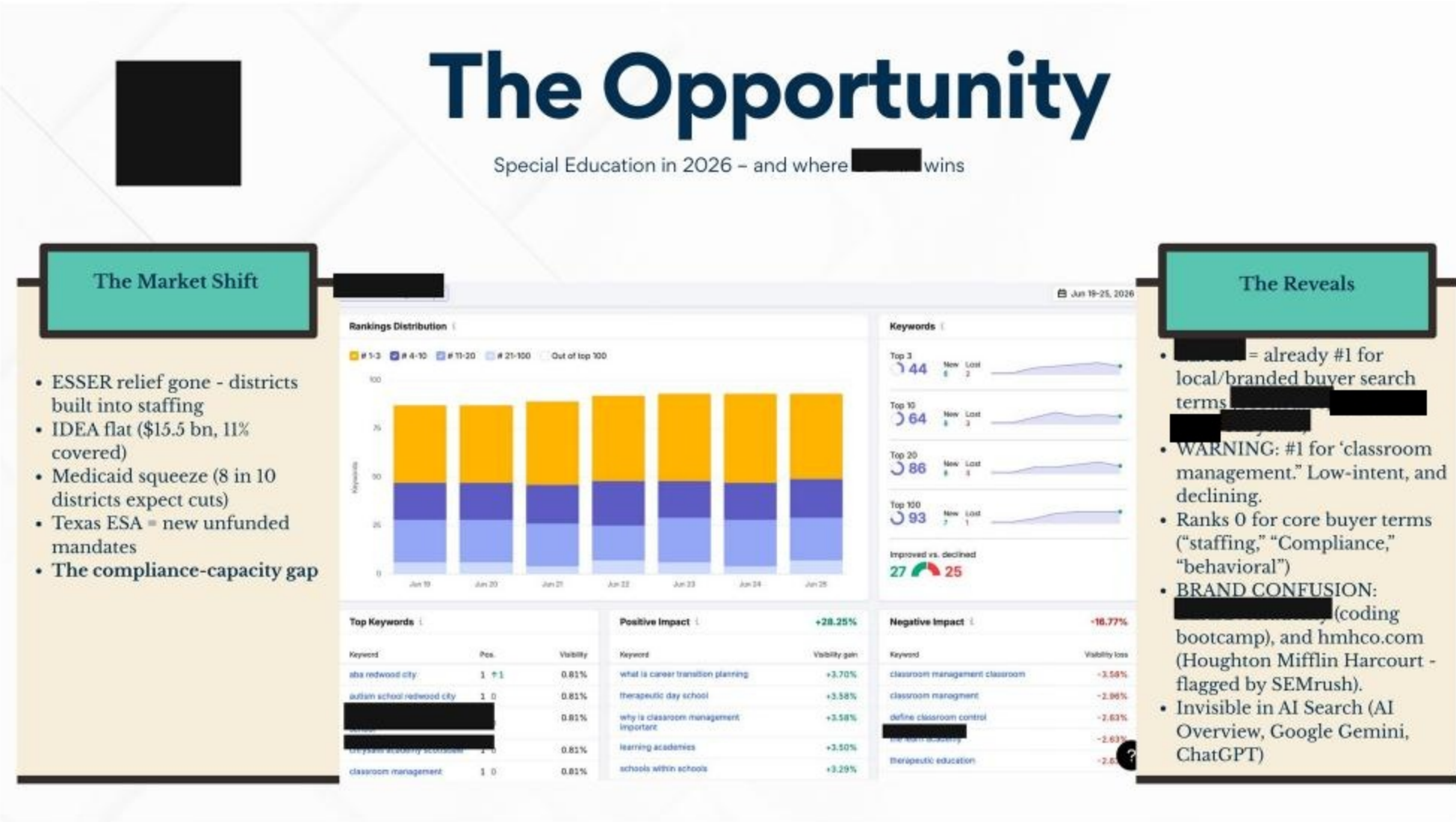


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Executive Summary



The Plan

This is a repeatable framework - evergreen, [REDACTED] can run monthly

Lead Generation + Thought Leadership

- Every piece CTA = "Schedule a call"
- Funnel: LinkedIn (awareness) → blog (consideration) → spotlight (decision)
- Spotlight maps funding pain → a billable [REDACTED] service = leads
- Anchors [REDACTED] to #1 SPED Director conversation of 2026
- Evergreen: reusable framework = "compliance-capacity"

Awareness
LinkedIn Series (3 pieces)

CONSIDERATION
Thought-leadership Blog

DECISION
Service Spotlight

"Schedule a call"

SEO and B2G Relevance

- Keywords chosen for district-buyer intent over raw volume
- Routed around brand collision → targets [REDACTED], local + service, not the bootcamp.
- LinkedIn over Meta and Pinterest. Buyer = director, not teacher.
- Keywords integrated into all three deliverables = build toward AI-search visibility (GEO)

Informative Blog

TITLE (Heading I): Mandates Up, Dollars Down: What 2026's Special Education Funding Shifts Mean for District Leaders

ALT Heading: Special Education Funding in 2026: What District Leaders Need to Know

Description (or, use for Google Search): ESSER is gone, Medicaid is shrinking, and Texas ESAs add new mandates. See how districts close the 2026 compliance-capacity gap. Schedule a call to see if [REDACTED] is right for your district.

URL SLUG: /special-education-funding-2026

IMAGE (if used): Include alternative text for visually-impaired readers.

It's the end of the school year - when budgets are renewed, staffing for next year gets decided, and classes are rebuilt. But, there's one insider event that we don't often see: the moment when a special education director stares down the math problem reshaping special education funding in 2026. The mandates haven't shrunk - kids still need aid. But... the money has.

Pandemic-era ESSER relief - which many districts used to build out their staffing - has run dry. Federal funding is flat and uncertain. What makes it harder is that the obligation to serve every student with a disability hasn't budged. It's always been a non-negotiable.

Understanding the forces reshaping special education funding in 2026 is no longer a "nice-to-have" - it's essential for district leaders trying to protect both their budgets and their students. Read on to understand what's changed since 2020 - and what the districts navigating it best are doing differently.

What's Behind the 2026 Special Education Funding Squeeze

Washington has never paid its share for special education. The Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA), passed in 1975, is the backbone of special education. It's what guarantees students with disabilities a free, appropriate, public education and the services that go with it - such as speech, OT, and behavioral support.

When IDEA passed in 1975, the federal government essentially promised to cover up to 40% of the extra cost of educating a student with a disability (basically granting "full funding"). The reality? It's never come close.

In fiscal year 2024, the Part B appropriation of the budget (\$14.2 billion) covered roughly 10.9% of that cost. Fifty years later, the math is the same. IDEA funding sits at around \$15.5 billion, essentially flat, and Washington still only covers around 11%. The rest has always fallen on state and local budgets, but that comes with strings attached. \$144 million was released in May 2026, and the Fiscal Year 2027 nudges the budget up by about 3.5%, but several support programs are being consolidated into single streams, and advocates are warning of eroded accountability.

How Medicaid Cuts Affect Special Education Staffing

And then, there's Medicaid - it's tightening, too. 86% of districts use Medicaid dollars for health and therapy staff salaries, and 8 in 10 anticipate they'll need to cut or lay off staff if Medicaid funding shrinks.

If this sounds counter-intuitive, it absolutely is - because districts must deliver IEP-mandated services with or without reimbursement, which means that any federal cut lands straight on the general fund. A federal cut doesn't make the obligation disappear; it just pulls the rug out from under it. Districts are forced to choose between their budget and their compliance.

Texas Special Education Funding: The 2026 ESA Case Study

Districts across the country are taking the steps to stay compliant. In Texas, the state launched Texas Education Freedom Accounts for the 2026-2027 school year, essentially giving up to \$30,000 to help fund students in need of

SPED. But, it's not as easy as "we'll just give you the money." Already under-staffed districts are required to upload IEPs and run evaluations for students suspected of a disability - and on a tight timeline. Meanwhile, private schools who are receiving the funds aren't required to provide special-ed services. At all. There is a severe compliance-capacity gap at play.

What's being framed as a great "policy change" is actually hiding new mandated work, and zero new funding to make it happen.

Closing the Compliance-Capacity Gap

Stack these forces, and you get the compliance-capacity gap: mandates steady or rising while the funded capacity to meet them is squeezed from every angle. But, the districts handling this best aren't waiting on Washington or the legislature. They're building flexible capacity: staffing and services that scale with demand, instead of locking in fixed costs they can't sustain. It's how they keep protecting special education compliance, closing the service gaps that lead to due-process complaints, and to the meeting every administrator dreads with a rightfully frustrated parent.

Special Education Staffing Solutions for 2026

The 2026 environment is unsettled, but navigable. [REDACTED] (connected with [REDACTED] Behavioral) understands this more than most. We provide the staffing and support districts need. We are your partner throughout this uncertain time, because we actually believe that no child should be excluded from a free and appropriate education. Let's close the gap together.

Schedule a call with us. There's a way through.

(NOTE: Include a link to the "our services" page as well)

Spotlight Piece

TITLE: Resource and Staffing Solutions: Flexible Special Education Staffing for Districts

(Meta title: Special Education Staffing Solutions for Districts | ██████████)

Meta Description: Open SPED roles put compliance - and kids - at risk. ██████████ places credentialed special education and behavioral staff fast, so services never stop. Schedule a call.

URL slug: /special-education-staffing-solutions

Note: Link “special education compliance review” in the body of this spotlight, directly to ██████████’s compliance review page. Link the final CTA “schedule a call” to the contact/schedule page.

SPOTLIGHT

Every special education director knows the feeling. The end-of-year budget cuts. Another classroom teacher is getting surplus-ed. The speech and language pathologist resigns in November. Three paraprofessional openings stretch into December, with no end in sight – because there’s just no money.

The hidden cost of an open SPED role

There’s a name for this. Well, a class size of names attached: children who depend on these services to access their right to a free, appropriate education. Students with services written into a legally binding plan. When budgets tighten and the district talent pool shrinks, the gaps multiply - fast. And a vacant role isn’t just a hiring headache; it’s a compliance exposure. More to the point, it’s a child not getting what they’re owed.

This is exactly the problem the ██████████ is built to solve.

Flexible capacity, not fixed cost

The budget crunch feels fixed – a hard number you can’t move. But, it doesn’t have to be. Rather than locking in permanent positions you may not be able to fund next year, you scale up when caseloads and evaluations surge, and down when they ease – so compliance is met no matter the scenario. That’s what special education staffing solutions are built to do.

A complete special education partner

Since 2007, ██████████ has built a national network of credentialed, vetted specialists. Our expertise spans the full range of roles a district actually needs: SLPs, OTs, PTs (and their assistants), school psychologists, social workers, counselors, BCBAs and ABA behavior technicians, special and general education teachers, nurses, and one-on-one aides. They’re available full-time, part-time, onsite, or virtual. We place them where you need them, fast, and back them with oversight that keeps your programs compliant, and your due-process risk down.

When a wave of evaluations hits – like the documentation crunch Texas districts face under new ESA rules – we surge qualified specialists to keep you on schedule.

What sets ██████████ apart is our partnership model. We don’t place-and-leave. ██████████’s deep special education background means we understand IEP and compliance management from the inside, so we work as part of your team – sharing data, aligning to your district’s compliance requirements, and adjusting as your caseloads shift. As one of our district partners, ██████████ put it, working with the ██████████ means not having to worry about documentation, nor the quality of staff.

And, because staffing rarely travels alone, our teams connect to ██████████’s broader support: special education compliance review, program management and oversight, and professional development, so the whole program moves in one unified direction. By providing a full complement of credentialed staff, research-based intervention,

and program consultation, [REDACTED] isn't here to do the minimum. [REDACTED] is here as a complete, cost-effective education partner.

Tight budgets shouldn't decide which students get served. [REDACTED] makes sure they don't have to.

Schedule a call with us.

Social Media

NOTES:

The best platform for this campaign is LinkedIn.

Going multi-platform would balloon this to a nine piece content strategy, as we need to be careful of the audience. District leaders and SPED directors.

Also, we need to be mindful of AI search. Google Gemini, Claude, and ChatGPT can crawl social media. LinkedIn content is increasingly surfaced in AI search; YouTube is less reliably indexed, so it's not a priority at the moment.

LinkedIn Post 1

Every special education director is doing the same math this spring.

And it doesn't add up.

ESSER relief is gone - and many districts had quietly built it into staffing.

The federal share is stuck near 11%.

Medicaid is tightening, and 8 in 10 districts expect to cut health staff if that funding shrinks.

But, the obligation hasn't moved an inch.

Every IEP is still a legal mandate.

Every service still has to be delivered, funded or not.

This is the compliance-capacity gap: rising mandates, shrinking capacity to meet them.

The question every director is facing this budget season: do you absorb it, or get ahead of it?

#SpecialEducation #districtfunding #educationbudget

LinkedIn Post 2

The compliance-capacity gap doesn't show up as a budget line. It shows up as an unfilled SLP position. It shows up as a speech therapist resigning in November. It shows up as an open role through the spring semester.

Meanwhile, a dozen students' IEP minutes go undelivered – and the clock on compliance keeps running.

Unfilled roles + rising demand = an impossible math problem.

Service gaps.

Due-process complaints.

Compensatory services owed to families.

Every month a role sits open, the district's exposure grows – and another student goes without the support written into their plan.

For directors and SPED leaders, the real budget risk isn't staffing up – it's staffing short.

There's a way through this – but it takes a partner who can fill the gap fast.

#SpecialEducation #SPEDcompliance #K12Leadership

LinkedIn Post 3

The funding picture is uncertain – but your ability to serve students doesn't have to be.

The districts filling the compliance-capacity gap aren't waiting on Washington to save them.

They're investing in credentialed special education and behavioral staff.

They're scaling up when evaluations surge.

They're working with partners instead of weathering the storm alone.

Compliance protected. Budget intact. Kids served.

That's what we do.

■■■■■■■■■■ partners with districts to do exactly this: to provide staffing and support to meet every mandate, even when the budgets are tight. From a single SLP to a full behavioral team, we help districts stay covered and compliant.

There's a way through.

Schedule a call with us.

#SpecialEducation #SpecialEducationStaffing #K12Leadership

Keyword List and Rationale

Keywords identified and validated using SEMrush (Keyword Magic Tool, Position Tracking, AI Search Visibility), Google Trends, and SERP Analysis. Volumes are US Monthly averages. — indicates below tool detection threshold (typical for niche B2G terms where at times, low volume = high intent)

Keyword	Intent	Volume (US/mo)	KD%	Rationale	Source
Special education staffing	Informational Maps to: Blog	170	33	Hero service, buyer intent	SEMrush, Keyword Magic Tool, Google Trends
Special education funding 2026	Informational Maps to: Blog	—	30	Blog primary keyword, thought leadership credibility building	SEMrush, Keyword Magic Tool, Google Trends
Special education compliance	Informational Maps to: Blog, Spotlight	70	16	Buyer pain, easy win (KD 16)	SEMrush
Medicaid school services	Informational Maps to: Blog	—	28	Timely policy, thought leadership, credibility building	SEMrush
ABA services	Commercial Maps to: Spotlight	8,100	61	Behavioral half of the brand; high value target	SEMrush, Google Trends, AnswerThePublic
The [REDACTED]	Commercial Maps to: Blog, Social, Spotlight	130	37	Brand name, buyer intent, value target. Branded term, it already ranks #1 when “the” is included. The brand name is contested, though, as just “[REDACTED]” with a similarly named San Diego company. Using the “the” is how [REDACTED] captures the buyer intent without contesting.	SEMrush
Texas education savings account	Informational Maps to: Blog (case study)	260	39	Timely geo long-tail spiking with the fall-2026 ESA launch; low competition = realistic first-page win.	SEMrush, Google Trends

Strategy note

This set spans both halves of [REDACTED]’s identity: special education AND ABA/behavioral services. [REDACTED] Behavioral has built broader brand and behavioral-term awareness, so [REDACTED] has the opportunity to cash in on that to get a boost in search (and AI visibility) to be seen as a thought leader. Branded SEO targets “the [REDACTED]” (already #1) rather than the bootcamp-dominated bare term. The other half of the brand, “[REDACTED] Behavioral” (around 1,600/mo) is a halo opportunity – link from it so authority flows to Academy pages. Local terms “autism school Redwood City” and one other regional branded term already rank #1, which is a parallel local-SEO play here.

(Note: [REDACTED]’s existing content skews family/clinical; the district-buyer lane this plan targets is currently underserved.)

This is a starting point, not a finish line. This month’s keywords establish [REDACTED]’s foundation on high-intent, district buyer terms. The longer play: [REDACTED] sits under [REDACTED] Behavioral (the more established brand). [REDACTED] Behavioral already ranks for a broad set of behavioral/ABA terms (ex: “[REDACTED] Behavioral,” 1,600/mo; “ABA Services,” 8,100/mo). [REDACTED] should capitalize on that

authority – through internal linking from the parent domain, shared content, and consistent cross-brand association, so the Academy's pages inherit the ranking momentum the Behavioral side has already built. Establishing thought leadership is a multi-month effort that is entirely possible. This plan is the repeatable first cycle (as the search landscape evolves).

Furthermore, once search moves up (Google, Bing, etc.), AI Visibility must be targeted (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini).